

Ethics Application Form

A.1 Applicant details

- Where you see an 'i' next to a question you'll find further advice and guidance to aid your completion of the questions.
- When completing your responses please ensure that you have provided sufficient detail that reviewers will have a clear understanding of all aspects of your project.
- Please note that only relevant questions will appear, depending on answers provided. Some questions may not appear.
- The University provides a range of template documents. We would strongly recommend that you use the templates that are available on the [research ethics and integrity website](#).

The University offers Research Ethics in Practice training online:

[Undergraduate & Postgraduate Taught Students](#)

A.1.1 Are you applying as a member of staff, a postgraduate research student, a postgraduate taught student (Masters) or an undergraduate student?

- ☐ Staff
- ☐ Postgraduate Research Student (e.g. PhD, ClinDoc)
- ☐ Postgraduate Taught Student (Masters e.g. MSc, MA, MRes, MPhil)
- ☒ Undergraduate Student

A.1.3 Please select your Faculty (or more than one if applicable).

- ☐ Faculty of Arts and Humanities
- ☐ Faculty of Health Sciences and Sport
- ☒ Faculty of Natural Sciences
- ☐ Faculty of Social Sciences
- ☐ Stirling Management School
- ☐ Other

A.1.4 Please enter the title of your degree programme.

BSc Software Engineering Honours

A.1.5 Please enter your module code.

CSCU9Z7

A.1.6 Please enter your student identification number.

3146279

A.1.7 Applicant details

First Name

Hareeshwar

Surname

Muthu Kumaran

Division

Faculty

Email

ham00411@students.stir.ac.uk

The information about you is completed automatically by the system. Do not worry if any of the fields are blank.

A.2 Supervisor contact details

Use the search function to select your supervisor.

Click on the **Assign Role** button next to the search function, use the dropdown list to select **Supervisor** and click **Share Role** to give your supervisor access to your form.

Please note your ethics application will not be submitted without their signature and you should work on the ethics application together.

The information about your supervisor is automatically completed. Please do not worry about blank fields.

A.2.1 Supervisor details

First Name

Shamik

Surname

Palit

Division

Faculty of Natural Sciences

Faculty

Email

shamik.palit@stir.ac.uk

A.2.2 Please confirm that you have used the Assign Role button to give your supervisor access to your form.

☒ I have assigned my supervisor to this form.

B.1 Type of application

B.1.1 Does your application involve any of the following?

- ☒ A project with human participants
- ☐ A project with animals
- ☐ STAFF/PGR ONLY: An application for a new project licence or an amendment to an existing project licence
- ☐ STAFF/PGR ONLY: A project that has received ethical approval external to the University
- ☐ None of the above

B.3 Additional factors

B.3.1 Does the proposed project involve reproducing copyrighted work in published form (other than brief citation)?

- ☐ Yes
- ☒ No

B.3.2 Does the proposed project involve activities which could temporarily or permanently damage or disturb the environment, or archaeological remains and artefacts?

- ☐ Yes
- ☒ No

B.3.3 Does the proposed project involve a potential conflict of interest or ethical issues regarding the source of funding or where the publication of research data may be restricted?

- ☐ Yes
☒ No

C.1 NHS, Invasive or Clinical Research

If **ANY** of the below options are selected, other than None of the Above, this application will be reviewed at the next possible meeting of **NICR** (NHS, Invasive or Clinical Research Ethics Panel).

If your project involves NHS patients, staff, data or premises, we would recommend using the [HRA Decision Tool](#) to determine whether NHS Research Ethics Committee approval will be required.

C.1.1 Please indicate those that apply to your project or select none of the above.

- ☐ Requires approval by an NHS Research Ethics Committee (REC).
- ☐ Requires approval ONLY by NHS Research and Development (R&D) with an IRAS form.
- ☐ Requires approval ONLY by NHS Research and Development (R&D) - no IRAS form is required.
- ☐ Involves NHS staff but does not require NHS REC or R&D approval e.g. service evaluation or audit.
- ☐ Residents in care homes.
- ☐ Individuals in custody or those selected because of their status as on probation or under court order.
- ☐ Health care settings (in the UK or overseas).
- ☐ Clinical trial or an investigational medicinal product.
- ☐ Clinical investigation and/or study of a medicinal product.
- ☐ Human tissue (e.g. skin, body parts, organs and bone).
- ☐ Sample-taking (e.g. urine, blood, hair, muscle biopsy).
- ☐ Imaging investigations (e.g. MRI, ultrasound, DXA, x-rays or radiation exposure).
- ☐ Physical examinations (e.g. blood pressure, pulse, respiratory rate).
- ☐ Physical tests (other than EEG, BioPac, fNIRS).
- ☐ Computer tests where there are potential health consequences (dementia, sleep apnoea, depression tests).
- ☐ Filming, photography or other recording (as part of a health research study or in a health setting/context).
- ☐ Ingestion of substances (e.g. foods, fluids or alcohol).
- ☐ Diagnostic questionnaires, surveys, interviews or focus groups, where there is the potential to diagnose new health related conditions.
- ☒ None of the above.

E.1 Project details

E.1.1 Please enter the short title of your project (max 200 characters). Editing this field will change the title of your form.

Sequential Transfer Learning for Medicinal Plant Identification: Endangered Species Protection and Sustainable Harvesting

You may need to revise this, if when creating the form you added 'dissertation' or 'thesis'. Your short and full title must be specific to your project.

Note: This is used when populating letters and correspondence.

E.1.2 Please enter the full title of your project, if different from the short title above.

E.3 Project duration

E.3.1 Project **START** date

15/09/2025

E.3.2 Project **END** date

05/04/2026

E.3.3 Please allow sufficient time for ethical approval to be granted. If the expected start date has passed this will revert to date ethical approval has been granted.

- ☒ I confirm that data collection/research activity will not start until ethical approval has been granted. If you have any concerns, please contact ethics@stir.ac.uk.

ONLY If different from the project start and end dates.

E.3.4 Expected start of data collection

25/11/2025

E.3.5 Expected end of data collection

15/12/2025

E.4 Location

E.4.1 Will **ANY** of your project be undertaken outside of the UK?

- ☐ Yes
- ☒ No

E.5 Health and Safety

If you are conducting any fieldwork a risk assessment must be signed off by your supervisor or line manager prior to starting. [Health and Safety Guidance](#).

Fieldwork is defined as: Any work carried out by staff or students for the purposes of teaching, research or other activities while representing the institution - [see full definition](#).

E.5.1 Has a health and safety risk assessment been completed?

- ☐ Yes
- ☒ Not applicable
- ☐ In progress - will be completed before fieldwork takes place.

F.1 Topic

Please give a brief (around 200-400 words) outline of the background, purpose and potential benefits of your project.

Please use plain English and explain any acronyms or specialist terms.

F.1.1 Topic

This project's problem and research questions focus on the ability to assess certain species of medicinal plants that are endangered for two specific stakeholder groups - forest rangers who need to know what's endangered to ensure protections and farmers who need to know what's allowed in inventory for safe harvesting within the national parks to avoid unnecessary charges. 15,000 species of medicinal plants are endangered across the globe and over 80% of the developing world utilize traditional medicine for most of their medicinal needs.

Currently, one can identify such plants via learned experience with botanical guides, which can be somewhat ambiguous since it takes time to learn with prolonged practical application and many plants are similar enough with certain identifying features that people misidentify them. Instead, CNN (convolutional neural networks) can identify certain species based on phytological assessments learned through deep learning via transfer learning - but little research exists that explores endangered species with small sample sizes and no one has attempted this new approach within niche findings for two, separated stakeholders.

This project will use novel sequential CNN transfer learning with five publicly available datasets of medicinal plants from data.mendeley.com, where 9,551 images of 37 species exist. This will involve four unique trainings for (1) generic characteristics of the medicinal plant, (2) localized characteristics (Bangladesh), (3) adjusted characteristics based on findings from endangered characteristics (4) commercially viable characteristics (south India).

The research is purely computational, utilizing pre-trained CNN architectures (ResNet50, EfficientNetB0, MobileNetV2) fine-tuned on publicly available datasets. No primary data collection, human testing, or field research is involved. All datasets are from verified repositories (Mendeley Data) with appropriate usage permissions.

Expected outcomes are (1) ranger-friendly/engaged automated systems will identify protected species to prevent illegal harvesting, (2) Farmers will receive validated reliable identifications based on confidence scoring that either allows them to proceed or will state they're not allowed, reducing legal liability and (3) This project also includes a small-scale usability evaluation with 6-8 university students, who will provide feedback on how understandable and clear the model's predictions and confidence scores are.

F.2 Main aims/objectives

Please give a brief summary (~200 words) of the main aims and objectives for your project.

Please use plain English and explain any acronyms or specialist terms.

F.2.1 Main aims/objectives

Primary Objectives:

1. Develop a sequential transfer learning model with multi-phase training pipeline targeting: (a) $\geq 75\%$ overall accuracy on independent test set (Dataset 3), (b) $\geq 95\%$ endangered species recall (Dataset 4 - REMP) for conservation enforcement, and (c) $\geq 95\%$ commercial species precision (Dataset 5 - SIMPD) to prevent protected species harvesting.
2. Conduct an ablation study to confirm that sequential transfer learning outperforms single-dataset training and joint training across all datasets simultaneously, as measured by accuracy and training time.
3. Confirm cross-regional applicability through Bangladeshi (Datasets 1, 2, 4) vs. South Indian data (Dataset 5) to evaluate generalization of the model.

Secondary Objectives:

4. Evaluate the CNN architectures (ResNet50, EfficientNetB0, MobileNetV2) to establish accuracy vs. efficiency trade-off for medicinal plant detection.
5. Conduct failure analysis to determine if species are likely to be misclassified with each other, interpret model decision-making, and verify botanical feature learning using Grad-CAM visualization.
6. Document project limitations (small endangered species dataset size, lack of real-world field testing, absence of direct user validation with farmers/rangers) with transparent assessment of generalization boundaries.

F.3 Methods

Describe the proposed methodology (200–400 words) for this project.

For example (this list is not exhaustive)

- fieldwork
- experimental procedures
- surveys
- interviews
- focus groups
- standardised testing
- video or audio recording
- textual analysis
- data analysis (including use of secondary data)

Broadly indicate why the methodology is appropriate to the project aims.

Please use plain English and explain any acronyms or specialist terms.

F.3.1 Methods

Methodology: Pure computational research using deep learning for image classification.

Data Sources:

Five publicly available medicinal plant datasets from data.mendeley.com (authorized repository recommended by University), totaling 9,551 original leaf images across 37 species:

- > Dataset 1: Medicinal Plant Identification (1,380 images, 6 species)
- > Dataset 2: Bangladesh Medicinal Leaves (1,094 images, 6 species)
- > Dataset 3: Medicinal Leaf Dataset (900 images, 9 species) - held-out test set
- > Dataset 4: REMP Endangered (3,494 images, 16 species) - rare/endangered Bangladeshi
- > Dataset 5: SIMPD South India (2,503 images, 20 species) - commercial species

All datasets are open-access with Creative Commons licensing. No personal data, copyrighted material, or proprietary information is used.

Technical Approach:
Sequential transfer learning using pre-trained CNN architectures (ResNet50, EfficientNetB0, MobileNetV2) from ImageNet. Four-phase training pipeline:

Phase 1: Pre-train on Dataset 1 (general medicinal features)
Phase 2: Fine-tune on Dataset 2 (regional Bangladesh adaptation)
Phase 3a: Fine-tune on Dataset 4 (endangered species specialization)
Phase 3b: Fine-tune on Dataset 5 (commercial species validation)
Evaluation: Independent testing on Dataset 3 (never seen during training)

Implementation Environment:

- Kaggle Notebooks (T4/P100 GPUs, 12-hour sessions)
- Google Colab (free tier for prototyping)
- Python libraries: TensorFlow/Keras, PyTorch, scikit-learn, Pandas
- Total estimated: 30-40 GPU-hours compute time

Evaluation Methods:

Quantitative metrics (accuracy, precision, recall, F1-score, confusion matrices), ablation studies (sequential vs single-dataset vs joint training), Grad-CAM visualization for model interpretability, cross-regional validation (Bangladesh vs South India datasets).

Human Subjects:

This research is primarily computational, analyzing only existing public datasets. No surveys, interviews, or new data collection are conducted. However, to evaluate interface clarity, 6–8 student volunteers will each join a single, brief session, view example model outputs, and answer a few questions about interpretability. No personal data is collected; participation is voluntary and anonymous.

No Animal Testing:

Project involves only digital image analysis. No live specimens, laboratory work, or field sampling is conducted.

Please be aware that if your methodology changes during your project, it is your responsibility to submit a change request form.

The University has a number of pre-approved [protocols](#) for common research scenarios. If you will be following one of the University's [protocols](#) please indicate which one here.

G.1 Student checklist

G.1.1 Please indicate all that apply to your project. If any of the below are selected, other than none of the above, this will require review by the Faculty GUEP Delegated Authority (General University Ethics Panel) at the end of the form.

- ☐ Your project involves individuals under the age of 18 (University students aged 16 or over are not usually considered to be a vulnerable group - unless vulnerable for another reason).
- ☐ Your project involves vulnerable adults who may not be able to give informed consent.
- ☐ Your project involves participants that may not be, or may not feel, able to freely consent to participate.
- ☐ Your project involves participants taking part without their consent or awareness.
- ☐ Your project involves a linking of personal data which may potentially compromise the anonymity of participants.
- ☐ Your project involves participants who have particular communication/linguistic or developmental requirements.
- ☐ Your project involves potentially sensitive topics (i.e. sexual activity, drug use, criminal activity).
- ☐ Your project involves participants taking part in activities that pose a significant risk to their personal well-being, social well-being or economic well-being.
- ☐ Your project will take place outside of the UK in a context where there may be issues of local practice and political sensitivities which need to be considered (e.g. where communities or public authorities may object to the project). This does not apply to all overseas projects.
- ☐ Your project involves the remote acquisition of data where the understanding of privacy or data ownership is contentious, where sensitive issues are discussed, or where an individual may be identifiable. For example, this may include identifying an individual's social media posts, but not running online interviews or surveys.
- ☒ None of the above.

N.1 GDPR

It is your responsibility to consider whether your project has any data protection implications. If any of the following circumstances apply to your project please discuss these with your supervisor to ensure the data protection risks are identified and minimised. Further guidance on how to assess and minimise risks by doing a data protection impact assessment are available on the [ICO website](#).

- Involves children or vulnerable adults.
- Involves personal data that has been obtained without the knowledge or the data subjects.
- Processing of bio-metric or genetic data (e.g. facial recognition, fingerprint verification, iris scanning, voice recognition, handwriting analysis).
- Large scale* processing of criminal convictions or special categories of personal data.
- Processing of personal data involving new technologies or novel applications of existing technologies.
- Combining or matching personal data obtained from multiple sources.
- Tracking individuals online or offline location or behaviour (e.g. use of cookies, geo-location).
- Using personal data in a way that could significantly affect or have an impact on an individuals.
- Jeopardising the physical health or safety of individuals.
- Systematic monitoring of publicly accessible areas (e.g. CCTV or recordings in public places).
- Profiling or automated decision-making on a large scale* where significant decisions are made impacting on people.

N.1.1 Applicants must confirm that they have read and understood the University's guidance on data protection / GDPR (General Data Protection Regulation) and that the necessary steps have been considered to protect the data of your participants.

Review the [University's guidance on data protection / GDPR](#)

- ☒ I have read and understood the University's GDPR guidance.

** Large scale processing takes into account the number of people affected by the processing (either as a number or proportion of the relevant population), the volume and range of data being processed, the duration and permanence of processing and the geographical extent of the processing.*

O.1 Ethical implications

O.1.1 Comment on any potential ethical risks involved in the project, and any steps taken to mitigate these risks. Please do not enter not applicable.

This is a computational study involving publicly available datasets from known sources on medicinal plants and convolutional neural networks that are pre-trained. No human or animal study participants, or personal or sensitive data are involved. All datasets are sourced from a reputable academic repository (data.mendeley.com) under open-access license.

The project will also conduct small-scale usability testing with 6–8 University of Stirling students to assess the clarity of model outputs. Participation is voluntary, anonymous, and no personal data will be collected; data consists only of non-identifying questionnaire responses.

The research supports endangered species protection and sustainable harvesting without publishing sensitive location or habitat data to prevent misuse. However, the geographical scale has been emphasized in the models - Bangladesh and South India - limitations on geographic generalization are transparently acknowledged in the dissertation.

Intellectual property is respected, with open-source model frameworks and careful code attribution. Standard academic integrity practices are followed throughout. Overall, the project poses minimal ethical risk, with appropriate attention to privacy, data licensing, conservation ethics, and dual-use considerations mitigated by limiting the sharing of sensitive data.

O.2 Potential risks

O.2.1 Are there risks or foreseeable harms that may be caused to participants and/or third parties.

For example, landowners, institutions, carers and families.

☐ Yes

☒ No

P.1 Inclusion and Exclusion Criteria

This section should set out precise details of which participants are eligible for your project, defining both inclusion and exclusion criteria. Inclusion criteria should define the population the project aims to include.

P.1.1 Please list all inclusion (selection) criteria.

Aged 18+, University of Stirling student, fluent in English, able to read a computer screen

Consideration should be given to: age range, health status (if relevant), occupation and capacity to consent.

P.1.2 Please list all exclusion criteria (those not eligible to take part).

Under 18, not a University student, unable to read a screen fluently in English, or significant visual impairment.

Consideration should be given to other factors that may exclude someone from taking part in the project, and not just mirror the inclusion criteria.

P.1.3 Please provide any other details of your participant population that might be of benefit to the Panel.

Participants will include a mix of technical (e.g., Computing, Data Science) and non-technical (e.g., Business, Accounting) students to help ensure the interface is understandable across disciplines.

P.2 Participants

P.2.1 How many participants do you intend to recruit? Please provide information per activity and if relevant a min-max range.

6–8 participants.

P.2.2 How was the sample size (how many participants) decided on?

You may wish to discuss any power analyses conducted, previous literature/theories or pilot studies.

This number is standard for qualitative usability testing and allows for effective feedback from a small, diverse group.

P.3 Vulnerable Groups

P.3.1 Does your project involve vulnerable groups?

Vulnerable groups include:

- Children and young people.
- Individuals with learning or communication difficulties.
- Older persons or adults with learning disabilities.
- Older persons or adults who fall under the remit of the Mental Capacity Act 2005/Adults with Incapacity (Scotland) Act 2000.
- Patients in care.
- Individuals in custody, on probation or under court order.
- Individuals engaged in illegal activity.

- ☐ Yes
- ☒ No

P.4 Recruitment

P.4.1 Describe how potential participants will be identified.

Identified through acquaintance network, classmates, and academic contacts in relevant courses across the university

P.4.2 Describe how potential participants will be recruited.

- Advert / Leaflet
- Email
- Advert on University Portal
- Poster
- Student Cohort
- Website
- Social Media
- Face to face
- Family / Friends / Colleagues
- Snowballing

Face-to-face invitation, WhatsApp, and informal contact through classmates, friends, and course mailing lists in Computing, Data Science, Business, and related departments

P.4.3 If relevant, please explain any additional arrangements made for participants who may have alternative or special communication needs (e.g. translation, use of interpreters, simplified language as appropriate).

P.5 Consent

P.5.1 How will you obtain consent from or on behalf of participants? When, where and how?

You could obtain consent through a written consent form, an electronic consent form or through oral consent at the start of an interview.

Please explain your methods of approaching participants, providing them with a participant information sheet and obtaining their consent to participate in the project. You should let the Panel know how long participants will be given to decide on their participation e.g. 48 hours.

If you are in a position of power over your participants explain how you will ensure that they are free from coercion or threats. You must not use your relationship or potential position of authority over participants to pressure them into taking part.

Participants should be informed of their right to withdraw from the study either during or after subject to established deadlines.

There is more information under the blue i button.

Each participant receives the information sheet at least 24 hours in advance. Written informed consent is collected in person before the session, after reviewing the information and answering any questions.

P.5.2 How will consent be recorded?

If written consent will not be obtained, justify it here.

Each participant signs a written consent form at session start, which will be stored securely.

P.6 Permissions

P.6.1 If any additional consent and permission procedures are required, please provide details.

For example, permissions to conduct field sampling or from local authorities to access schools.

No additional permissions or external consents are required. All activities are conducted with university students on campus.

Q.1 Incentives

Q.1.1 Will participants / owners receive any payments (including vouchers and prize draws), reimbursements of expenses or incentives for taking part in this project?

- ☒ Yes
☐ No

Q.1.1.1 Please detail any incentive participants may receive for participation.

Please include the value of the incentive.

How participants will receive compensation e.g. bank transfer/voucher.

Please explain why the incentive is appropriate compensation for participation in this project.

Participants may receive a small thank-you (e.g. chocolate) after the session. This is a nominal incentive for their time, not a payment for results.

For applications that will provide Psychology Undergraduate students with research tokens please ensure that your study follows the Undergraduate Student Participation in Research in the Psychology Division Research Tokens Protocol available from the [approved protocol section of the website](#). You should make reference to the protocol in your answer here.

Q.2 Methodologies

Q.2.1 Will the proposed project involve the deception of participants?

- ☐ Yes
☒ No

Q.2.2 Will the proposed project involve concealment or covert observation?

- ☐ Yes
☒ No

Q.2.3 Is the project design emergent? e.g. will elements of the project be developed over the course of the project?

- ☐ Yes
☒ No

Q.3 Location

Q.3.1 List the locations or sites where the study activities will take place.

for example: online, in a classroom, in a sports facility.

University of Stirling campus, in a computer lab or quiet study space. All sessions are face-to-face

Q.4 Dissemination

Q.4.1 How will the results from this study (including feedback to participants) be disseminated?

For example (list not exhaustive); dissertation, thesis, reports, conference presentations and/or journal articles.

Please include details of how the information will be shared with participants? E.g. on request, through an email list

Findings will be included in the final undergraduate dissertation, submitted to the University of Stirling. Participants' data will remain anonymous. Summary results are available to participants on request by email.

R.1 Data collection methods

R.1.1 Does the proposed study involve the acquisition of data from or about human participants using the internet and its associated technologies?

- ☐ Yes
☒ No

For example; online video recording, data from social media, responses to internet surveys.

R.1.3 Does the proposed work involve collecting or accessing records of, personal or confidential information concerning individuals?

- ☐ Yes
☒ No

R.1.7 Does the proposed project involve the recording of participants through the use of audio visual methods? (e.g. are you recording interviews or focus groups, either with a phone/audio recorder, or in Teams, Zoom or another online platform?)

- ☐ Yes
☒ No

R.2 Research activity

R.2.1 Will any third-party agencies be used for collecting data (e.g. YouGov, Prolific).

- ☐ Yes
☒ No

S.1 Data analysis

S.1.1 How do you intend to analyse the data (statistical or other appropriate methods, e.g. for qualitative research) to meet the study objectives?

Quantitative data (model accuracy, recall, precision) will be summarized with descriptive statistics. Usability test ratings from participants will be analyzed using averages and simple counts to identify clarity trends. Any written questionnaire responses will be reviewed for common themes to improve interface design

S.2 Data storage

Please note the distinction between **research** data and **personal** data.

Personal data - participants' names, contact details etc. should only be kept for as long as is necessary.

Research data - qualitative or quantitative data on which research conclusions are made.

Undergraduate and Postgraduate Taught Students

All electronic data should be stored in password protected files on your University OneDrive account. Data should not be stored on your laptop/PC or on a USB drive. Hard/paper copies of documents should be locked away securely. Data must not be disclosed to any third party unless participants are informed of the disclosure. Data should be safely destroyed within a reasonable timescale after graduation (e.g. six months). If a journal article or external report is considered based on the study, research data should be kept for longer and copies lodged with dissertation supervisors.

S.2.1 Explain and justify your proposals for retention and disposal of any **PERSONAL** data to be collected.

Personal data includes - participants' names, date of birth, contact details. Personal data should only be kept for as long as is necessary.

Personal data will not be collected. All participant responses are anonymous; no names or contact details are recorded.

S.2.2 Explain/justify your proposals for retention and disposal of any **RESEARCH** data to be collected.

Anonymous questionnaire forms and researcher notes will be stored securely on the researcher's University OneDrive and in a locked drawer during the research period. Data will only be retained until dissertation submission and marking is complete, then deleted in accordance with University policy (within six months of graduation)

T.1 Conflict of interest

T.1.1 Please consider if any potential conflict of interest could arise in this project;

For example

- Research funded from a commercial or public organisation seeking 'evidence' to support their agenda.
- Relationships between organisations/participants/researchers where there is a power dynamic which could bias the project.
- Personal or financial relationships.

- ☒ No conflict of interest identified.
- ☐ Potential conflict of interest identified.

V. Documents

The University provides a range of template documents. We would strongly recommend that you use the templates that are available on the [research ethics and integrity website](#). You'll find the templates under Ethics template documents.

Please provide an English translation of all documentation.

If you are an undergraduate or a postgraduate taught student, you must get these documents approved by your supervisor before you start your data collection.

V.1 Participant information sheets

V.1.1 Please upload your participant information sheet(s). Please upload participant information sheets and ensure they are understandable for each participant group and activity (e.g. adults and children, survey and interview).

Documents					
Type	Document Name	File Name	Version Date	Version	Size
Participant information sheet	Participant Information Sheet	Participant Information Sheet.pdf	15/11/2025	1	208.0 KB

If uploading a participant information sheet for an online survey, that includes a consent form, then a separate consent form is not required.

V.2 Consent sheets

V.2.1 Please upload your consent form(s). Please ensure they are understandable for each participant group and activity.

Documents					
Type	Document Name	File Name	Version Date	Version	Size
Consent Form	Participant Consent Form	Participant Consent Form.pdf	15/11/2025	1	147.2 KB

V.3 Recruitment materials

22 November 2025

Reference #: GUEP 2025 24485 18893

V.3.1 Please upload copies of recruitment material(s) e.g. posters, social media posts, or email invitations.

V.4 Questionnaires and interview guides

V.4.1 Please attach copies of questionnaire(s), interview, focus group guides or similar documents.

Type	Document Name	Documents			
		File Name	Version Date	Version	Size
Interview schedule/topic guide	User Testing Tasks	User Testing Tasks.pdf	15/11/2025	1	4.0 MB

V.5 Debrief information

V.5.1 If relevant, please attach copies of debrief information.

V.6 Other supporting documents

V.6.1 If relevant, please attach other documentation.

W.1 Applicant

W.1.1 Please read and confirm the following statements:

- ☒ You have provided sufficient detail throughout the application to give a clear understanding of your project and explained any abbreviations or technical terms.
- ☒ You have checked any supporting documents for spelling/grammatical/syntax errors and where required added content/trigger warnings.
- ☒ Those involved with the project are aware of the content of the application.
- ☒ Where required, templates have been used for all Participant Information Sheets, consent forms and all outward facing documents include the University logo, your ethics reference and the version number and date.

Please note you should not sign your form until your supervisor has seen it and told you that it is ready to be signed.

Signing the form will lock the form and prevent further editing. If you choose to unlock the form all signatures will be invalidated and requests will need to be made again.

W.1.2 Please sign your application.

Signed: This form was signed by Hareeshwar Muthu Kumaran (ham00411@students.stir.ac.uk) on 22/11/2025 8:49 AM

Once you have signed your form please scroll down to request your supervisor's signature.

W.2 Request supervisor declaration

You should only request your supervisor's signature once you have reviewed the form together and have agreed the content.

W.2.1 Please request your supervisor's signature.

Signed: This form was signed by Shamik Palit (shamik.palit@stir.ac.uk) on 22/11/2025 9:05 AM

W.3 Request second reviewer declaration

For Supervisors ONLY

Once you are happy to approve this application please request the signature of the second reviewer for this application.

You must also sign the application yourself!

W.3.1 Please request approval from the second reviewer for this application.

Signed: This form was signed by Narina Thakur (narina.thakur@stir.ac.uk) on 22/11/2025 7:24 AM